



▲ CHASSEPOT PERCUSSION CARBINE

Date 1858

Origin France

Weight 3.03kg (6¾lb)

Barrel 72cm (28¼in)

Calibre 13.5mm

In France, Chassepot produced a breech-loading carbine that used a rubber washer to seal the breech. The later, definitive Chassepot system replaced the hammer with a needle striker within a turn-bolt.



"Monkey tail"
breech lever

Lock plate

▲ WESTLEY RICHARDS "MONKEY TAIL" CARBINE

Date 1866

Origin UK

Weight 3kg (6½lb)

Barrel 45.5cm (18in)

Calibre .45in

Birmingham gun-makers Westley Richards produced two carbines for the British Army. This one had a front-hinged, tilting breech with a long, curved actuating lever, which gave the weapon its nickname.



Rear sight

Barrel band anchoring
the barrel in stock

◀ MARTINI-HENRY MK I

Date 1871

Origin UK

Weight 4.7kg (10¼lb)

Barrel 85cm (33½in)

Calibre .45 Martini

The British Army's first purpose-designed, breech-loading rifle, the Martini-Henry incorporated a tilting breech block. Lowering the under-lever opened the breech and cocked the action.



Bolt handle

Rear sight is graduated
up to 1.6km (1 mile)

◀ SPRINGFIELD TRAPDOOR

Date 1874

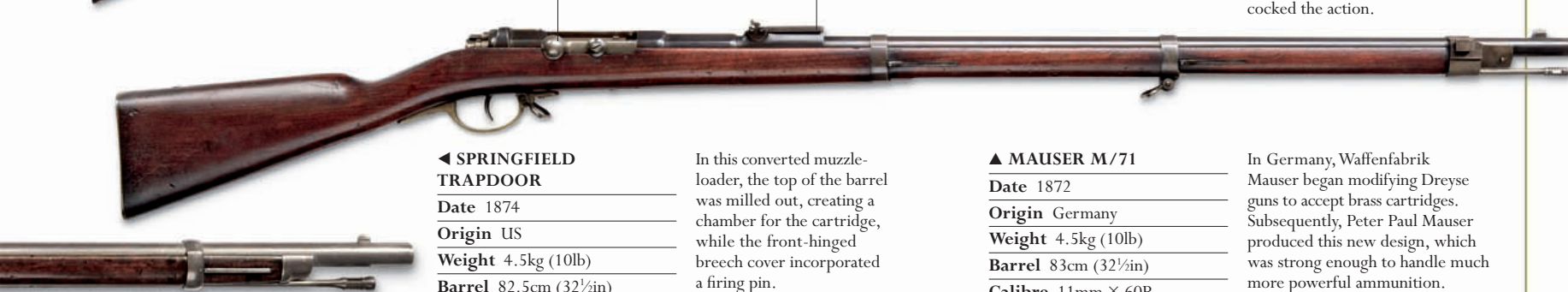
Origin US

Weight 4.5kg (10lb)

Barrel 82.5cm (32½in)

Calibre .45in

In this converted muzzle-loader, the top of the barrel was milled out, creating a chamber for the cartridge, while the front-hinged breech cover incorporated a firing pin.



▲ MAUSER M/71

Date 1872

Origin Germany

Weight 4.5kg (10lb)

Barrel 83cm (32½in)

Calibre 11mm × 60R

In Germany, Waffenfabrik Mauser began modifying Dreyse guns to accept brass cartridges. Subsequently, Peter Paul Mauser produced this new design, which was strong enough to handle much more powerful ammunition.